difference in terms of the substance of the political economy formed with the PNO and SNDP respectively. The gypsum concession obtained by the SNDP is nothing compared to Nay Win Tun's jade mine. However, this is not the only reason why ceasefire capitalism did not work in southern Shan State. The role of the beneficiaries at different levels of the power chain and the structure of the informal economy also made a difference. In the Pa-O areas, the PNO controls villagers through village tract leaders, and village tract leaders are rewarded for settling disputes and they receive bribes. There is a coherent formal structure and informal arrangements for an authoritarian political order. By contrast, the SNDP does not enjoy the luxury of having an army to back its cause, and the layer of beneficiaries is not there to deliver political objectives at the micro level. These findings lend support to the claim by Aspinall and As'ad that partnering with the right broker is essential in delivering political objectives, and substantiate the suggestion by Wong that frontier strongmen can be co-opted into the state's project.

However, this line of analysis, which tends to emphasize the importance of patronage and authority, may be too simplistic and ignores the significance of soft power. If patronage, power, and finding the right broker are all that matter, why can the model not be replicated in other parts of the country? Why was the PNO the only pro-establishment ethnic political party that managed to retain all its seats in 2015? The PNO victory cannot be boiled down to authority over villagers. Better voter education and the presence of international observers reduced the scope for electoral manipulation. One cannot dismiss the possibility that some Pa-O people voted wholeheartedly for the PNO instead of the UPNO and NLD.

This brings the local CSOs into the debate. The analysis presented in the chapter places CSOs as "enemies" of the state. Their advocacy for self-determination and democracy appealed to many young Pa-O voters. However, what tangible benefits have these CSOs actually brought to the Pa-O community as a whole? In response to the challenge by these CSOs, the PNO set up PDN in 2012 to repair pagodas, and build roads and schools. Many old villagers said that before 1991 they had to pay tax to the government but after the PNO became the administrator of their areas, they did not have to.[30] These are tangible benefits that Pa-O villagers appreciate. PNO candidates conducting their election campaigns in monasteries speaks volumes about their relationship with monks, who are highly respected by Pa-O people.[31] This soft power that the PNO has